

LISTENING

#37

1 – Listen to a man taking part in a job interview for a teaching position. Pay attention to his education, previous work experience, current jobs, teaching methods, language skills, and what will happen after the interview.

Job Interview – A Strong Candidate

1 - How long ago did the man graduate with his English and psychology degrees?

2 - Where did he get his first job overseas?

3 - Where did he work after leaving the private language school?

- a) At an international high school
- b) At a community college
- c) At a professional cooking school

4 - What two subjects did he teach?

5 - Why did his culinary students need to learn English?

- a) To communicate with suppliers and international customers
- b) To apply for jobs at restaurants in other countries
- c) To understand recipes written by famous foreign chefs

6 - What brought the man back to the United States?

7 - What other work has the man been doing besides working at the sushi restaurant?

- a) Counseling teenagers at a treatment center
- b) Advising students at a community college
- c) Teaching cooking classes at a private school

8 - What three reasons does the man give for being the best person for the teaching position?

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

A Second Chance at an Interview

Daniel had been looking for a job when he found an opening at a software company. The position was in customer support, and it required someone who could communicate clearly, solve problems, and remain calm under pressure. Daniel had worked in an electronics store for five years, so he believed his experience was relevant.

He prepared for the interview. He researched the company, reviewed the job description, and practiced describing situations in which he had helped difficult customers. However, on the morning of the interview, his bus broke down. When another bus did not arrive, Daniel realized he would be late.

He immediately called the company, explained the situation, and apologized. The receptionist said the hiring manager had another interview soon, but she would ask whether Daniel could still be seen.

Daniel arrived fifteen minutes late. He apologized and expected the interview to be canceled. Instead, the manager invited him into her office and asked how he handled unexpected problems.

Daniel described an incident at the electronics store. A customer had become angry because a laptop stopped working two days after purchase. Although the store was crowded, Daniel listened patiently, checked the receipt, and arranged a replacement. He also helped the customer back up files.

The manager then asked why Daniel wanted to leave his job. He explained that he was grateful for what he had learned, but he was ready to take on new responsibilities and improve his skills.

At the end of the interview, the manager said Daniel had made a strong impression. His phone call had shown responsibility, and his answers demonstrated that he could stay calm under pressure.

Two days later, Daniel was invited to a second interview. He had not received an offer, but he felt relieved that the delay had not ruined his opportunity.

Comprehension Questions

1 - What experience made Daniel a suitable candidate for the position?

2 - What did Daniel do when he realized he would be late?

3 - Why did the manager have a positive impression of Daniel?

4 - What do you think a candidate should do if they are going to be late for an interview?

5 - Have you ever had to deal with an unexpected problem at work or school? What happened?
